Paolo Nessim

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Education

- **Montgomery College** Germantown, MD
  Associate of Arts in Computer Science; GPA: 3.58/4.0 *Expected May 2027*
  - Dean's List; Phi Theta Kappa Honor Society; Southern Management Leadership Program (SMLP) Scholar
  - Planned transfer: University of Maryland, B.S. Cyber-Physical Systems Engineering (Universities at Shady Grove), Fall 2027; expected May 2029

Experience

- **University of Maryland, A. James Clark School of Engineering** College Park, MD
  Research Intern, Cyber-Physical Systems Engineering (CPSE) *Aug 2025 – Present*
  - Built a real-time computer-vision pipeline (Python, OpenCV) that detects and tracks physical chessboard state for the Magic Gambit v2 robotic chess system, driving robotic-arm motion planning from live piece movement.
  - Designed the system's custom ESP32 (WROOM-32E) controller PCB: schematic capture with zero ERC errors, USB-C programming with CH340C auto-reset, ESD protection, and a TPS61022 boost power chain, sourced against the LCSC catalog for JLCPCB fabrication.
  - Implemented an ESP-NOW wireless link to a RoArm-M2-S robotic arm and a real-time web interface for live board-state visualization and control.
- **University of Maryland, CPSE Summer Program** College Park, MD
  Hardware/Software Engineer *Jun 2025 – Aug 2025*
  - Developed "ICantSee," an assistive proof-of-concept combining live computer vision with haptic feedback so visually impaired users can sense obstacles in real time.
  - Selected from the summer cohort to continue as an academic-year CPSE research intern.
- **NASA L'SPACE Mission Concept Academy** Remote
  Computer Engineering Participant *Jan 2026 – May 2026*
  - Designed a space mission concept through Preliminary Design Review (PDR) on a multidisciplinary team, producing NASA-standard engineering documentation across systems, science, and operations sub-teams.
- **Nessimworks, Web Development & Software Services** Germantown, MD
  Full-Stack Developer & UI Designer *Jan 2023 – Present*
  - Design, ship, and maintain production websites for small-business and nonprofit clients (React, Next.js, Tailwind CSS), owning requirements gathering, delivery, and Git-based deployment workflows end to end.

Projects

- **Snipprompt — Chrome Extension SaaS**: Freemium prompt-snippet manager live on the Chrome Web Store with paying subscribers ($9/mo Pro tier); Plasmo (Manifest V3), Next.js, Better Auth, Stripe, Neon Postgres + Drizzle ORM. Owned the full product lifecycle solo, including Chrome Web Store review recovery across four submissions.
- **Beacon — Self-Hosted Error Tracking Platform**: Lightweight Sentry alternative: Python ingestion core and REST API covered by 49 tests, React (Vite) dashboard, Python and Node.js client SDKs, Docker multi-stage builds, LLM cost tracking, and alerting.
- **OpenChess — Smart Chessboard Hardware**: Physical chessboard on a custom ESP32 PCB with 64 hall-effect sensors for magnetic piece detection, a WS2812 LED matrix for move feedback, and an OLED interface; plays online via Lichess.
- **Satgaze — Real-Time 3D Satellite Tracker**: Browser-based visualization rendering live positions of 24,000+ satellites via SGP4/TLE orbital propagation (Next.js, TypeScript, Three.js/WebGL).

Leadership & Activities

- Co-Lead, AI Project Team, Raptors Who Code (Montgomery College), Feb 2024 – Present; MC AI Club member; open-source contributor.

Skills

- **Languages**: Python, C/C++ (embedded), TypeScript/JavaScript, Java, SQL
  Hardware & Embedded: Schematic capture & PCB design (KiCad), ESP32, ESP-NOW, Arduino, hall-effect & haptic sensor integration, oscilloscopes, circuit prototyping; Fusion 360, Onshape
  Software: OpenCV, React, Next.js, Node.js, Docker, Stripe, PostgreSQL (Neon, Drizzle), Tailwind CSS, Git, Linux